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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 20

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Reserva de una sala de estudio

Librarian: Good morning, Central Library help desk. How can I help?

Student: Hi, I'd like to reserve a group study room for my project team.

Librarian: Certainly. Can I take your name?

Student: Yes, it's Daniel Okoro.

Librarian: Before we begin the formal record, I should explain how I handle a study-room reservation. I will check the main requirement first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Student: That approach would be helpful for the study-room reservation. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Librarian: Could you spell your surname for me?

Student: Of course - O-K-O-R-O.

Librarian: Thank you, Daniel. And a phone number in case we need to reach you?

Student: It's 07811 402596.

Student: For this study-room reservation, I am not simply looking for the cheapest possibility. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Librarian: Of course. In this study-room reservation, I will flag any condition that depends on availability, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Librarian: Great. What are you studying, so I can note it on the booking?

Student: I'm doing a degree in economics.

Librarian: How interesting. Is this your first time booking a room with us?

Student: It is, actually. A classmate told me the rooms here are really useful for group work, so I thought I'd give it a try.

Librarian: A study-room reservation can involve names, dates and choices that differ in only one important detail. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Student: I will. For the study-room reservation, I would prefer to correct a small point now, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Librarian: They certainly are, especially at this time of year. Now, which floor would you like? We have rooms on the second and third floors.

Student: I thought the second floor at first, but I'll take the third floor - it's much quieter up there.

Librarian: The third floor it is. And how many people is the room for?

Student: There'll be six of us altogether.

Librarian: Let me finish the study-room reservation by summarising what I have recorded. For this study-room reservation, I will repeat the selected arrangement, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the study-room reservation, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Student: Good. During the study-room reservation, I will listen carefully and make sure no assumption has slipped in.

Librarian: Fine. Do you need any particular equipment? Most rooms have a whiteboard, and some also have a projector.

Student: A projector would be ideal, as we're rehearsing a presentation.

Librarian: Noted. And which day do you need it?

Student: Thursday, if that's free.

Student: Before we close the study-room reservation, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Librarian: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Librarian: Thursday's fine. Just remember to bring your student card, as you'll need it to collect the key.

Student: Will do. Could you tell me about the rooms and the charges?

Librarian: Certainly. Room A is on the third floor, holds six people, and costs three pounds an hour. It comes with a whiteboard.

Student: And something bigger?

Librarian: Before I close this study-room reservation, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Student: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Librarian: Room B is on the fourth floor. It seats ten, costs five pounds an hour, and includes a projector, which is perfect for your presentation.

Student: Then I'll take Room B for Thursday.

Librarian: Excellent. I'll book that in for you now.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Guía del museo del transporte

Welcome to the National Transport Museum. I'm your guide for this morning, and I'll give you a quick overview before you go off to explore on your own. Before describing the individual features of this transport-museum guide, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the transport-museum guide follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, moving from the arrival point to the places that need closer explanation. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the transport-museum guide easier to follow. Let me start with our recent improvements. Over the winter we completely renovated two of our galleries.

The tram gallery has been redesigned with interactive displays, and the aircraft gallery now has a full-size cockpit that you can actually sit in. The steam-train hall, the bicycle collection and the motorcycle gallery are unchanged this year, though they're all still well worth a visit. Some arrangements connected with the transport-museum guide may have changed since older information was prepared. During the transport-museum guide, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time. Where a condition in the transport-museum guide is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. Now some practical information.

The museum stays open until five o'clock, but last entry to the exhibits is at four thirty, so please plan your time. Photography is allowed everywhere except in the model railway room, where the flash disturbs the delicate mechanisms. If you'd like something to eat, the café is on the ground floor, right next to the gift shop. As the transport-museum guide continues, access and movement need to remain clear for everyone. Within the transport-museum guide, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the transport-museum guide, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available.

For families, we run a treasure hunt every afternoon; just pick up a worksheet from the information desk. Children particularly enjoy the driving simulator, though I should mention there's a small extra charge of two pounds for that. Do not try to memorise every detail of the transport-museum guide at once. The route will make more sense once its main stages are connected. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. A final way to follow the transport-museum guide is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. Examples make the layout memorable, but only stated directions determine the route.

Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. A few quick reminders. Large bags must be left in the cloakroom near the main entrance. Our guided tours leave every hour from the central hall, and each one lasts about forty minutes. And if you happen to get lost, look for a member of staff in a red jacket - they'll be glad to point you in the right direction. If you become uncertain during the transport-museum guide, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking. Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence.

This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity. Finally, before you leave, do go up to the viewing platform on the top floor, which gives a wonderful view over the old railway yard. And on your way out, we'd be really grateful if you could fill in a short questionnaire about your visit, because your comments genuinely help us improve. Right - enjoy the museum. Before the transport-museum guide moves to its final practical details, remember that similar locations or services may have different conditions. Listen for the full name, the direction attached to it and any time restriction.

A descriptive example may help you recognise a place, but only a direct instruction tells you to change route or take action. If a temporary arrangement replaces the normal one, the replacement will be stated after the original is identified. This final distinction connects the earlier overview with the choices that follow and helps prevent a familiar name from being confused with the service currently available.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Plan de una campaña de salud pública

Tutor: So, Priya and Sam, let's plan your public-health campaign. You'd chosen to look at students' diets. Where did you finally land?

Priya: We decided to concentrate on sugary drinks specifically, rather than diet in general - it felt far more manageable.

Tutor: I think that's wise. Last year a group tried to cover every aspect of healthy eating, and their message ended up completely diluted.

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the public-health campaign, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Priya: Agreed. For the public-health campaign, we can identify which claims are supported and which remain tentative. That will make the argument more credible.

Tutor: Good - a narrow focus usually works better. And who's your target audience?

Sam: We were going to aim at the whole campus, but in the end we've decided to target first-year students, since their habits are still forming.

Priya: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the public-health campaign. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. We should match the strength of each claim to the method.

Tutor: Sensible. Now, what's your main message going to be?

Priya: At first we thought we'd emphasise the health risks, but the research suggests that frightening people rarely changes behaviour. So we'll stress the money students could save instead.

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the public-health campaign are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Priya: For the public-health campaign, let us include one clear example and one borderline case. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Tutor: Yes, the cost angle is often more persuasive. How will you actually reach students?

Sam: We considered posters, but honestly almost nobody looks at them now. We think social media will have far more impact.

Priya: The order of the public-health campaign presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the public-health campaign, we can use the assessment criteria as a final checklist rather than relying on whether the draft feels polished.

Tutor: That matches what the studies show - students spend hours scrolling on their phones but walk straight past a poster on the wall.

Tutor: I agree. Now, one real challenge with campaigns like this is measuring success. How will you know if it has worked?

Tutor: Our final review of the public-health campaign should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Priya: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can sign off each requirement before calling the revision complete.

Priya: We'll run a survey before and after the campaign, and then compare the results.

Tutor: That's exactly the right approach. Let me suggest some practical steps. First, don't start filming until you've written a clear script. Second, you'll need approval from the ethics committee before you collect any data at all. Third, book the recording equipment early, because it's in very high demand. And keep a copy of everything in a shared folder, so nothing gets lost. Finally, compare the survey results to judge the campaign's success.

Priya: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the public-health campaign, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Sam: That's really helpful - thanks. We'll divide up the tasks and send you a full plan by the end of the week.

Tutor: Perfect. I look forward to seeing it.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: La historia del chocolate

Today I'm going to talk about the history of chocolate, which stretches back over three thousand years. To place the history-of-chocolate lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the history-of-chocolate lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through small changes whose significance became visible only later. A simple list of events in the history-of-chocolate lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. Chocolate comes from the seeds of the cacao tree, which grows in the tropical regions of Central and South America. The first people to use it were the ancient Olmec, but it was the Maya and later the Aztecs who truly valued it.

They ground the roasted seeds and mixed them with water to make a bitter drink. Interestingly, the seeds were also used as a form of currency - you could actually buy everyday goods with cacao beans. Evidence for the history-of-chocolate lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare controlled findings with patterns observed outside the laboratory. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. When Spanish explorers reached the Americas in the sixteenth century, they carried chocolate back to Europe. There, people added sugar to the drink to make it sweeter, and it quickly became a fashionable luxury among the wealthy.

For a long time chocolate stayed expensive, because processing the beans by hand was extremely slow. Scale is especially important when evaluating the history-of-chocolate lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this history-of-chocolate lecture, examples at different scales will therefore be compared. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. Everything changed during the Industrial Revolution. New machinery made it possible to produce chocolate on a large scale, and prices began to fall. A major breakthrough came in 1828, when a Dutch chemist invented a press that removed much of the fat, leaving a smooth powder that was far easier to use.

It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the history-of-chocolate lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. The final account should separate established patterns from reasonable inference. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together. The separate examples in the history-of-chocolate lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the history-of-chocolate lecture, that structure keeps chronology from becoming a list of disconnected facts.

The conclusion to the history-of-chocolate lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. The solid chocolate bar we know today appeared a few decades later. Manufacturers found that adding extra cocoa butter produced a bar that would melt in the mouth. Soon afterwards, the addition of milk created milk chocolate, which

became hugely popular, especially with children. A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the history-of-chocolate lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together.

Today chocolate is a global industry worth billions. However, it faces serious challenges. Most cacao is now grown in West Africa, where farmers often receive very low prices for their crop. There are also environmental concerns, since expanding plantations can lead to deforestation. For that reason, many companies now promote products certified as sustainable. So next time you eat a chocolate bar, remember its remarkable journey through history. One final point about the history-of-chocolate lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation. A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation.

Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.